

02

The Locked e5 Center

The pawn chain, its base, and why kingside space creates both attacking chances and strategic obligations.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will recognize the classical KIA battlefield and know which squares, pawn breaks, and piece routes arise from the e5 wedge.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate White's candidates, find Black's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 007 | PAGE 4

Decode: The e5 space wedge*e5 buys kingside space; White must use the space before Black attacks its base.*

LESSON 008 | PAGE 8

Play: The e5 space wedge*e5 buys kingside space; White must use the space before Black attacks its base.*

LESSON 009 | PAGE 12

Decode: The d3 base of the chain*Attack from the head of the chain, but protect the base with the fewest pieces possible.*

LESSON 010 | PAGE 16

Play: The d3 base of the chain*Attack from the head of the chain, but protect the base with the fewest pieces possible.*

LESSON 011 | PAGE 20

Decode: The d4 outpost*In the KIA, d4 is the square White concedes; monitor who can use it and why.*

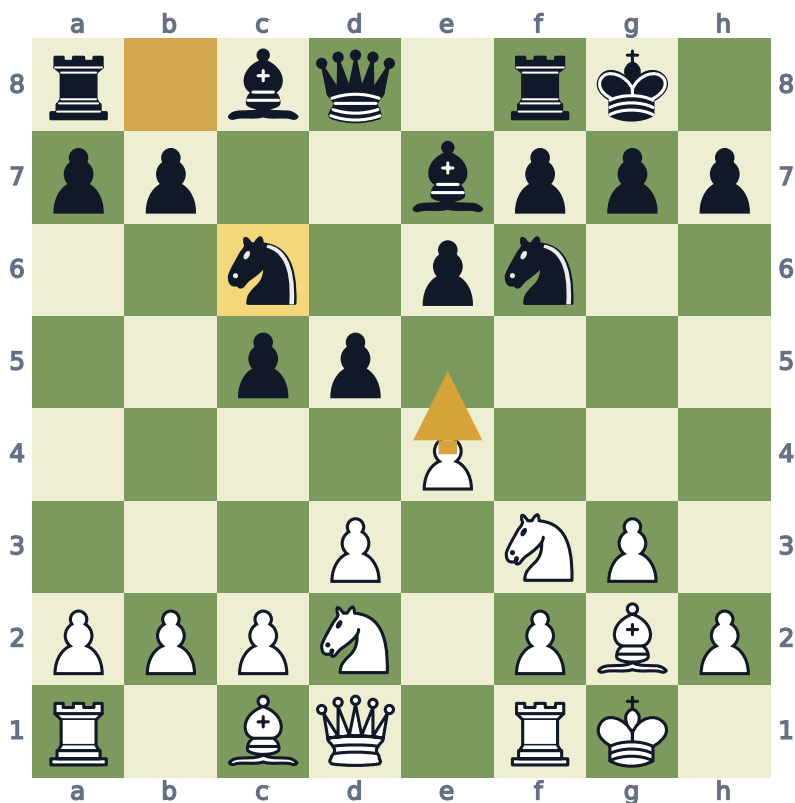
LESSON 012 | PAGE 24

Play: The d4 outpost*In the KIA, d4 is the square White concedes; monitor who can use it and why.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will recognize the classical KIA battlefield and know which squares, pawn breaks, and piece routes arise from the e5 wedge.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The e5 space wedge

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

e5 gains kingside space, restricts the f6 knight, and closes the center, making a wing attack plausible while fixing d3 as the pawn-chain base.

DECISION RULE

Can Black undermine e5 immediately, and which defender or recapture keeps White's pieces active?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black attacks the chain with ...f6, gains queenside space, and uses the d4 square before White's kingside pieces coordinate.

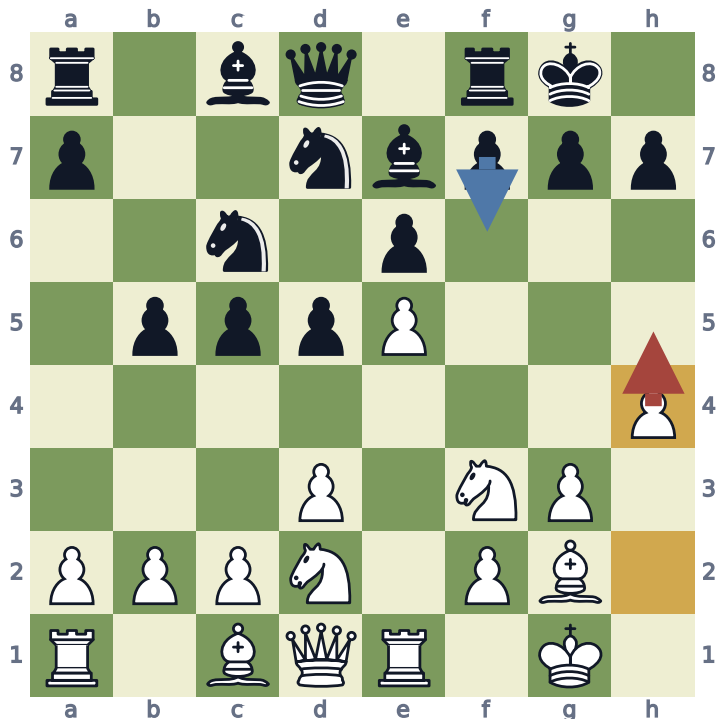
WHITE'S PLAN

White keeps e5 supported, reroutes pieces toward the king, and uses h4, Nf1-h2-g4, or Bf4 before opening lines.

MEMORY RULE | e5 buys kingside space; White must use the space before Black attacks its base.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

e5 gains kingside space, restricts the f6 knight, and closes the center, making a wing attack plausible while fixing d3 as the pawn-chain base.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black attacks the chain with ...f6, gains queenside space, and uses the d4 square before White's kingside pieces coordinate.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White keeps e5 supported, reroutes pieces toward the king, and uses h4, Nf1-h2-g4, or Bf4 before opening lines.

FAILURE MODE

Advancing e5 without a route for the f3 knight or enough support for the pawn chain.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Can Black undermine e5 immediately, and which defender or recapture keeps White's pieces active? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

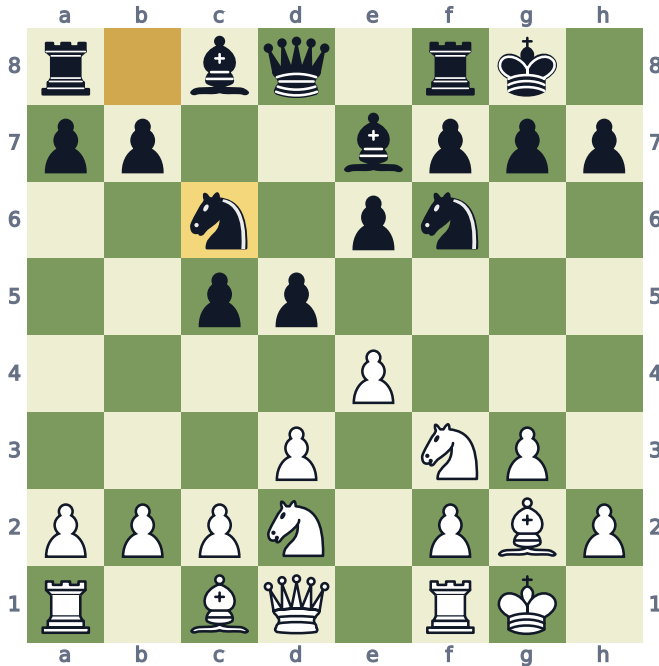
RULE | e5 buys kingside space; White must use the space before Black attacks its base.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4



- g3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

e5 gains kingside space, restricts the f6 knight, and closes the center, making a wing attack plausible while fixing d3 as the pawn-chain base.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Can Black undermine e5 immediately, and which defender or recapture keeps White's pieces active? White's attacking or positional plan is: White keeps e5 supported, reroutes pieces toward the king, and uses h4, Nf1-h2-g4, or Bf4 before opening lines. The line fails as a template when: Advancing e5 without a route for the f3 knight or enough support for the pawn chain.

STORE THIS | e5 buys kingside space; White must use the space before Black attacks its base.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

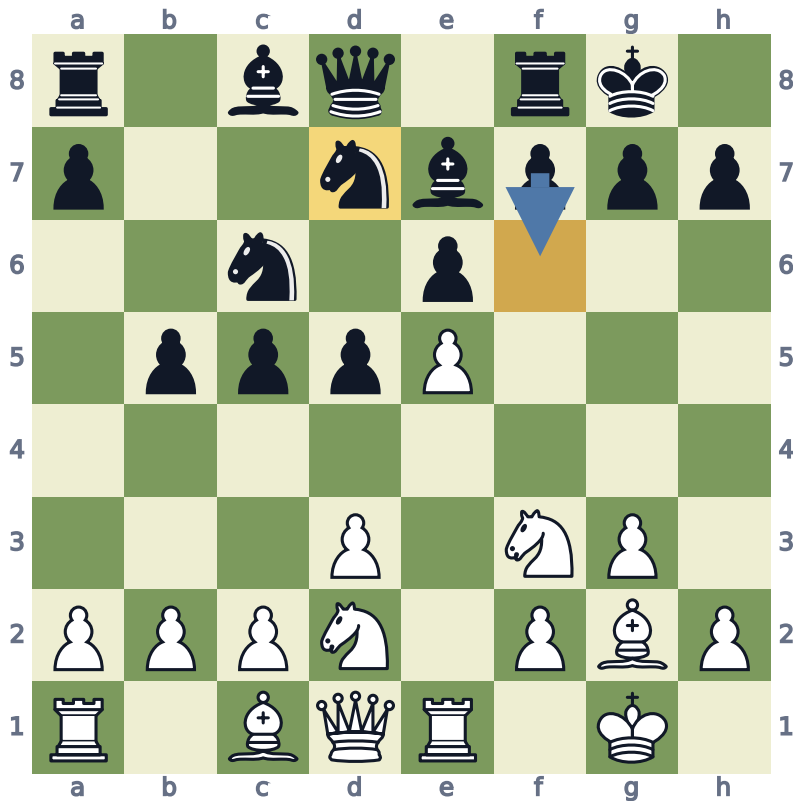
1. e5 gains kingside space, restricts the f6 knight, and closes the center, making a wing attack plausible while fixing d3 as the pawn-chain base. 2. Black attacks the chain with ...f6, gains queenside space, and uses the d4 square before White's kingside pieces coordinate. 3. White keeps e5 supported, reroutes pieces toward the king, and uses h4, Nf1-h2-g4, or Bf4 before opening lines. 4. Can Black undermine e5 immediately, and which defender or recapture keeps White's pieces active? 5. Advancing e5 without a route for the f3 knight or enough support for the pawn chain.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The e5 space wedge



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

e5 gains kingside space, restricts the f6 knight, and closes the center, making a wing attack plausible while fixing d3 as the pawn-chain base.

DECISION RULE

Can Black undermine e5 immediately, and which defender or recapture keeps White's pieces active?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black attacks the chain with ...f6, gains queenside space, and uses the d4 square before White's kingside pieces coordinate.

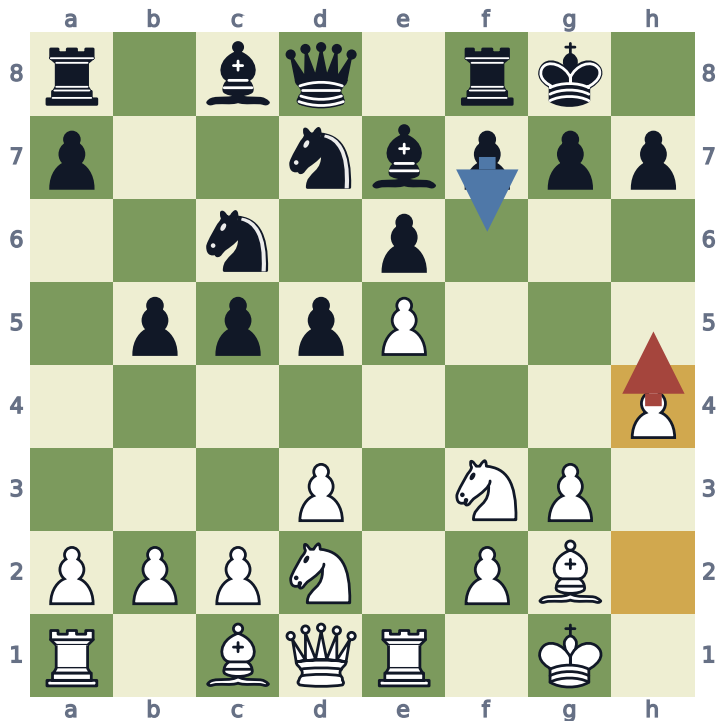
WHITE'S PLAN

White keeps e5 supported, reroutes pieces toward the king, and uses h4, Nf1-h2-g4, or Bf4 before opening lines.

MEMORY RULE | e5 buys kingside space; White must use the space before Black attacks its base.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

e5 gains kingside space, restricts the f6 knight, and closes the center, making a wing attack plausible while fixing d3 as the pawn-chain base.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black attacks the chain with ...f6, gains queenside space, and uses the d4 square before White's kingside pieces coordinate.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White keeps e5 supported, reroutes pieces toward the king, and uses h4, Nf1-h2-g4, or Bf4 before opening lines.

FAILURE MODE

Advancing e5 without a route for the f3 knight or enough support for the pawn chain.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Can Black undermine e5 immediately, and which defender or recapture keeps White's pieces active? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

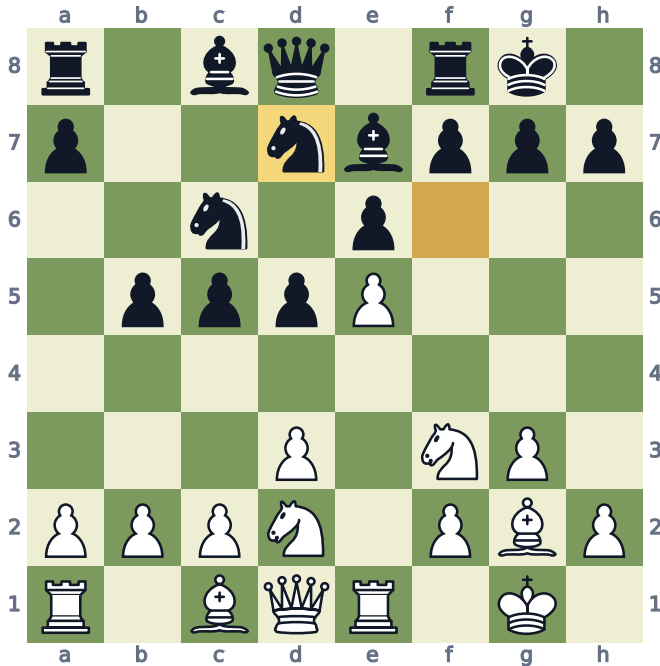
RULE | e5 buys kingside space; White must use the space before Black attacks its base.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4



- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.
- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

e5 gains kingside space, restricts the f6 knight, and closes the center, making a wing attack plausible while fixing d3 as the pawn-chain base.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Can Black undermine e5 immediately, and which defender or recapture keeps White's pieces active? White's attacking or positional plan is: White keeps e5 supported, reroutes pieces toward the king, and uses h4, Nf1-h2-g4, or Bf4 before opening lines. The line fails as a template when: Advancing e5 without a route for the f3 knight or enough support for the pawn chain.

STORE THIS | e5 buys kingside space; White must use the space before Black attacks its base.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

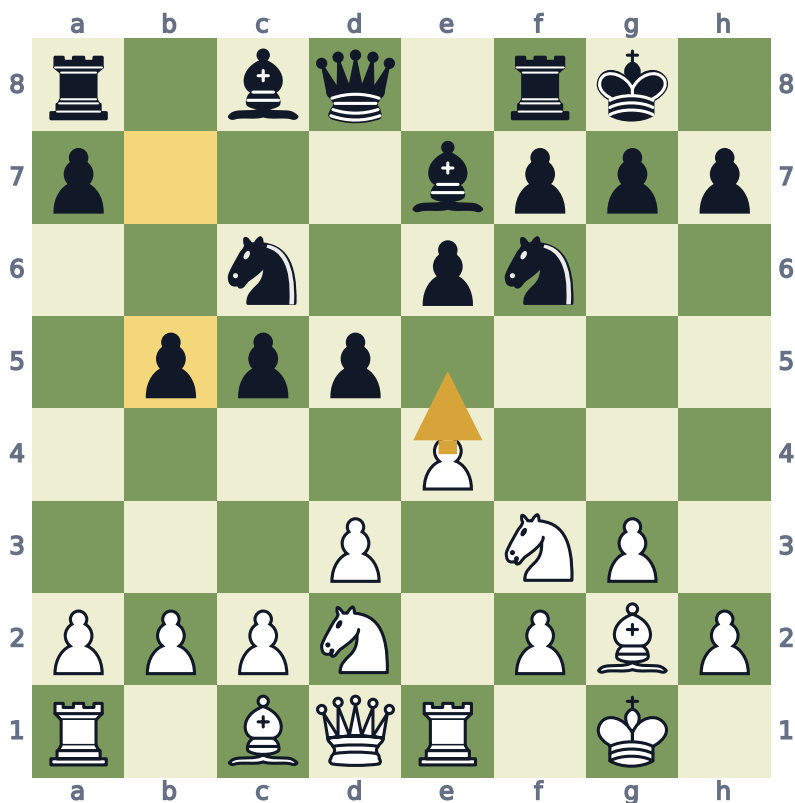
1. e5 gains kingside space, restricts the f6 knight, and closes the center, making a wing attack plausible while fixing d3 as the pawn-chain base. 2. Black attacks the chain with ...f6, gains queenside space, and uses the d4 square before White's kingside pieces coordinate. 3. White keeps e5 supported, reroutes pieces toward the king, and uses h4, Nf1-h2-g4, or Bf4 before opening lines. 4. Can Black undermine e5 immediately, and which defender or recapture keeps White's pieces active? 5. Advancing e5 without a route for the f3 knight or enough support for the pawn chain.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The d3 base of the chain

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

The advanced e5 pawn is only as stable as d3 and the pieces behind it; pressure on d3 can make the whole attacking structure brittle.

DECISION RULE

Which black piece can attack d3, and can White meet it with development rather than passive defense?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black combines ...b5-b4, ...a5, and ...Ba6 or ...f6 so White must defend d3 while attacking elsewhere.

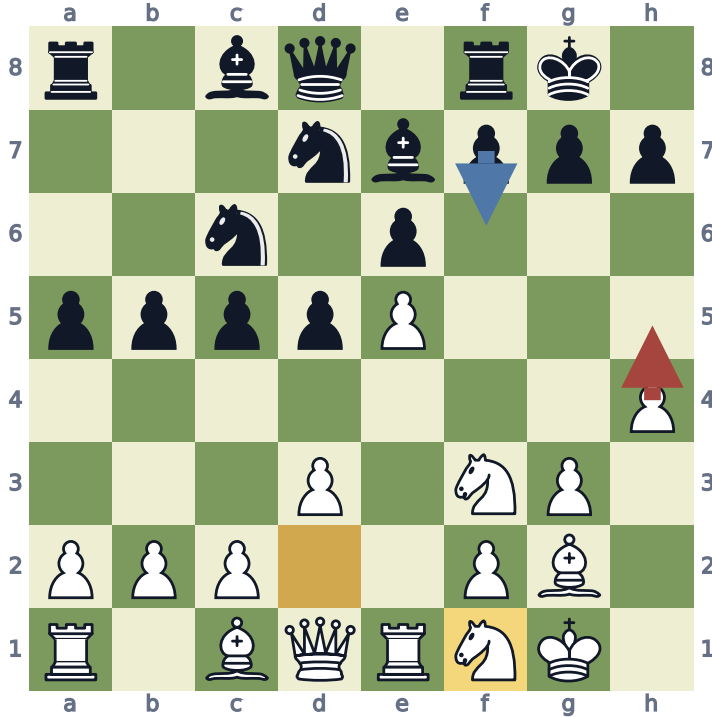
WHITE'S PLAN

White defends d3 economically, clears d2 for pieces, and avoids tying the queen and rooks to a static weakness.

MEMORY RULE | Attack from the head of the chain, but protect the base with the fewest pieces possible.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The advanced e5 pawn is only as stable as d3 and the pieces behind it; pressure on d3 can make the whole attacking structure brittle.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black combines ...b5-b4, ...a5, and ...Ba6 or ...f6 so White must defend d3 while attacking elsewhere.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White defends d3 economically, clears d2 for pieces, and avoids tying the queen and rooks to a static weakness.

FAILURE MODE

Concentrating every piece on the kingside while the chain's base falls with tempo.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which black piece can attack d3, and can White meet it with development rather than passive defense? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

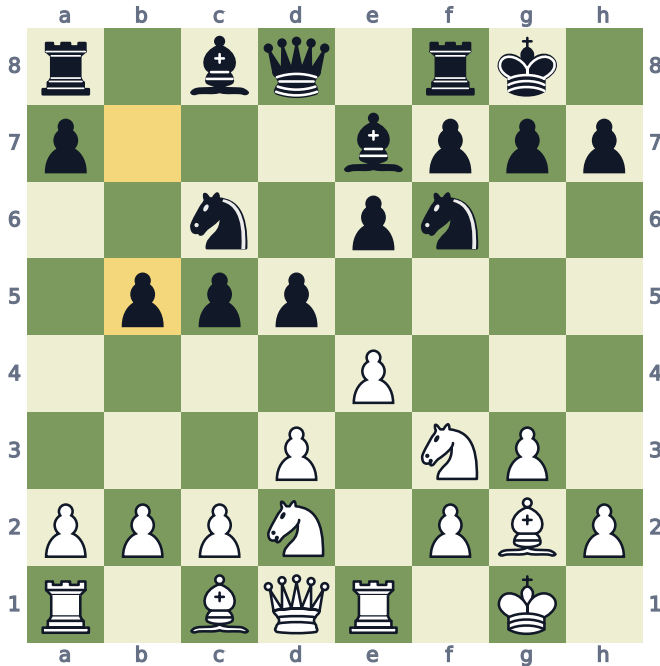
RULE | Attack from the head of the chain, but protect the base with the fewest pieces possible.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1



- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The advanced e5 pawn is only as stable as d3 and the pieces behind it; pressure on d3 can make the whole attacking structure brittle.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which black piece can attack d3, and can White meet it with development rather than passive defense? White's attacking or positional plan is: White defends d3 economically, clears d2 for pieces, and avoids tying the queen and rooks to a static weakness. The line fails as a template when: Concentrating every piece on the kingside while the chain's base falls with tempo.

STORE THIS | Attack from the head of the chain, but protect the base with the fewest pieces possible.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

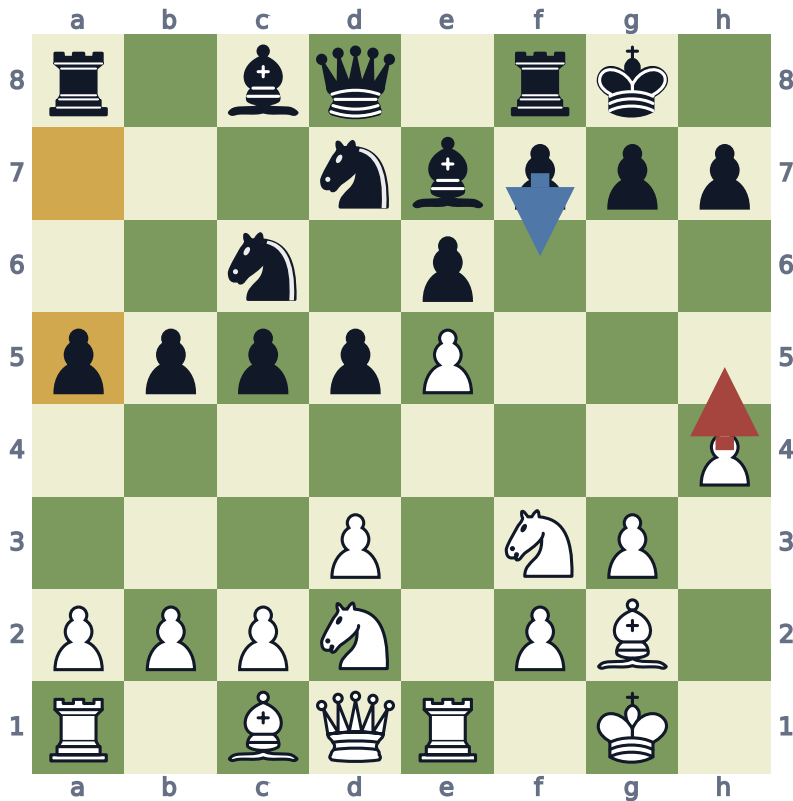
1. The advanced e5 pawn is only as stable as d3 and the pieces behind it; pressure on d3 can make the whole attacking structure brittle. 2. Black combines ...b5-b4, ...a5, and ...Ba6 or ...f6 so White must defend d3 while attacking elsewhere. 3. White defends d3 economically, clears d2 for pieces, and avoids tying the queen and rooks to a static weakness. 4. Which black piece can attack d3, and can White meet it with development rather than passive defense? 5. Concentrating every piece on the kingside while the chain's base falls with tempo.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The d3 base of the chain



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The advanced e5 pawn is only as stable as d3 and the pieces behind it; pressure on d3 can make the whole attacking structure brittle.

DECISION RULE

Which black piece can attack d3, and can White meet it with development rather than passive defense?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black combines ...b5-b4, ...a5, and ...Ba6 or ...f6 so White must defend d3 while attacking elsewhere.

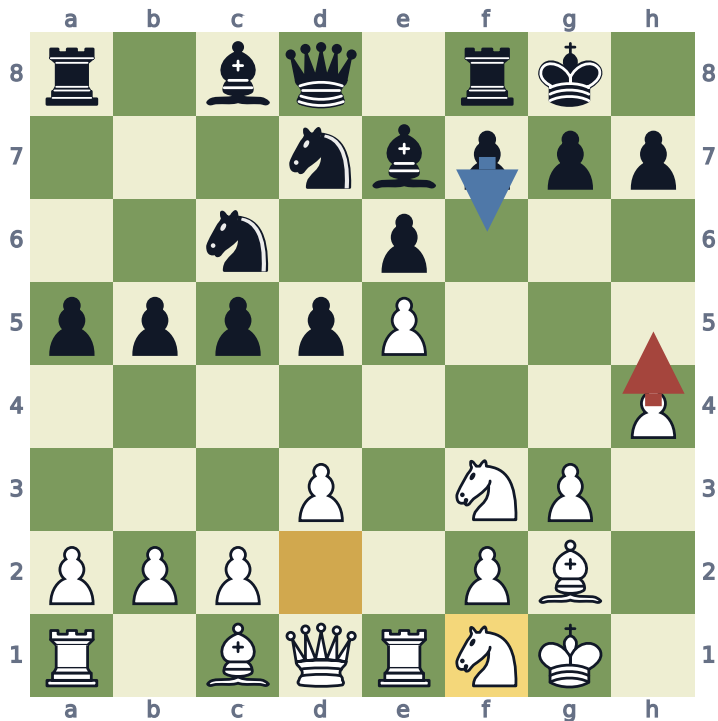
WHITE'S PLAN

White defends d3 economically, clears d2 for pieces, and avoids tying the queen and rooks to a static weakness.

MEMORY RULE | Attack from the head of the chain, but protect the base with the fewest pieces possible.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The advanced e5 pawn is only as stable as d3 and the pieces behind it; pressure on d3 can make the whole attacking structure brittle.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black combines ...b5-b4, ...a5, and ...Ba6 or ...f6 so White must defend d3 while attacking elsewhere.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White defends d3 economically, clears d2 for pieces, and avoids tying the queen and rooks to a static weakness.

FAILURE MODE

Concentrating every piece on the kingside while the chain's base falls with tempo.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which black piece can attack d3, and can White meet it with development rather than passive defense? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

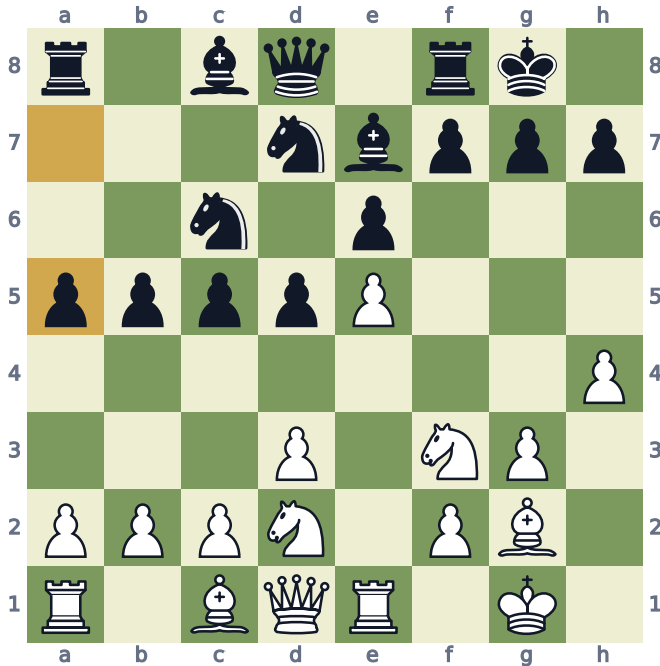
RULE | Attack from the head of the chain, but protect the base with the fewest pieces possible.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1



- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.
- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- h4: White creates a possible kingside hook and supports h5.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The advanced e5 pawn is only as stable as d3 and the pieces behind it; pressure on d3 can make the whole attacking structure brittle.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which black piece can attack d3, and can White meet it with development rather than passive defense? White's attacking or positional plan is: White defends d3 economically, clears d2 for pieces, and avoids tying the queen and rooks to a static weakness. The line fails as a template when: Concentrating every piece on the kingside while the chain's base falls with tempo.

STORE THIS | Attack from the head of the chain, but protect the base with the fewest pieces possible.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

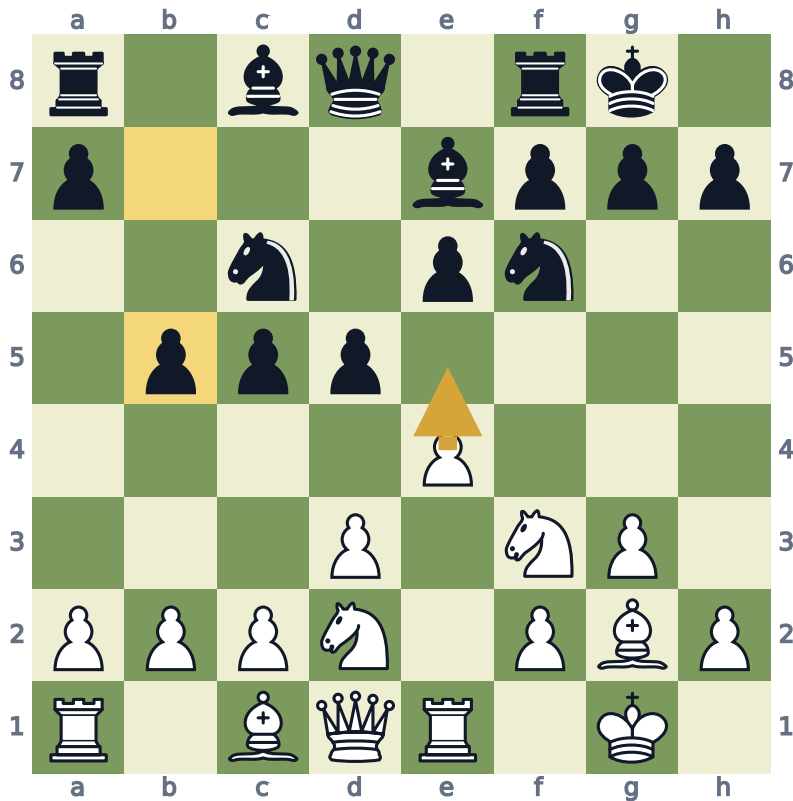
1. The advanced e5 pawn is only as stable as d3 and the pieces behind it; pressure on d3 can make the whole attacking structure brittle. 2. Black combines ...b5-b4, ...a5, and ...Ba6 or ...f6 so White must defend d3 while attacking elsewhere. 3. White defends d3 economically, clears d2 for pieces, and avoids tying the queen and rooks to a static weakness. 4. Which black piece can attack d3, and can White meet it with development rather than passive defense? 5. Concentrating every piece on the kingside while the chain's base falls with tempo.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The d4 outpost



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Because White's pawn stands on d3 rather than d4, Black often receives the d4 outpost for a knight or bishop and can use it to interrupt the attack.

DECISION RULE

Is d4 a harmless square, a blockading square, or an entry square that creates a concrete threat?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black occupies d4 when it cannot be chased, exchanges a key attacker, and coordinates queenside pressure with the central outpost.

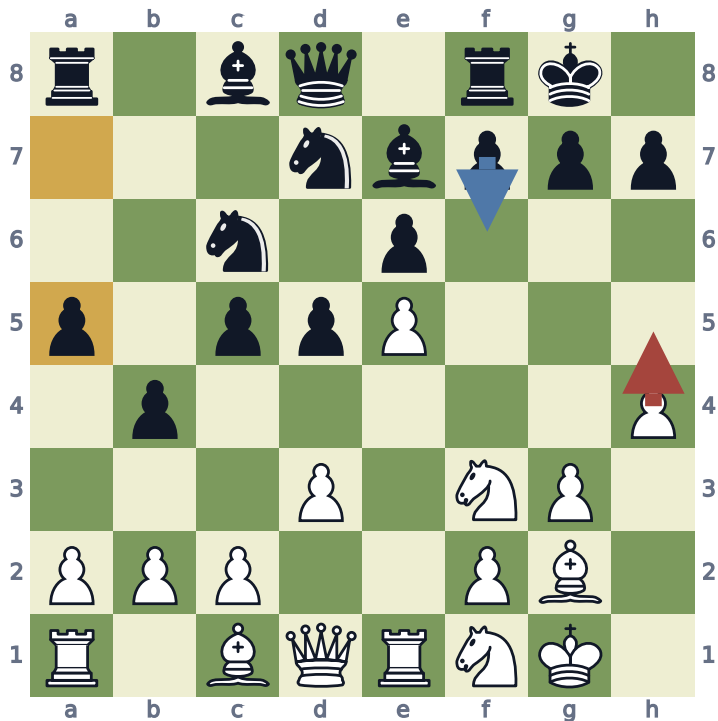
WHITE'S PLAN

White controls d4 with c3 or reroutes pieces so an occupation can be exchanged without ruining the attack.

MEMORY RULE | In the KIA, d4 is the square White concedes; monitor who can use it and why.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Because White's pawn stands on d3 rather than d4, Black often receives the d4 outpost for a knight or bishop and can use it to interrupt the attack.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black occupies d4 when it cannot be chased, exchanges a key attacker, and coordinates queenside pressure with the central outpost.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White controls d4 with c3 or reroutes pieces so an occupation can be exchanged without ruining the attack.

FAILURE MODE

Treating the closed center as completely safe while a black piece dominates d4.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Is d4 a harmless square, a blockading square, or an entry square that creates a concrete threat? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

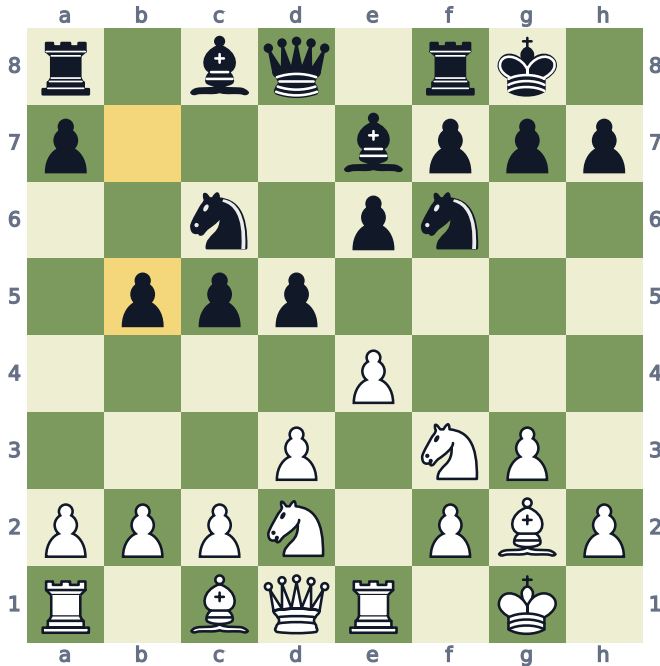
RULE | In the KIA, d4 is the square White concedes; monitor who can use it and why.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 b4 11. Nf1 a5



- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Because White's pawn stands on d3 rather than d4, Black often receives the d4 outpost for a knight or bishop and can use it to interrupt the attack.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Is d4 a harmless square, a blockading square, or an entry square that creates a concrete threat? White's attacking or positional plan is: White controls d4 with c3 or reroutes pieces so an occupation can be exchanged without ruining the attack. The line fails as a template when: Treating the closed center as completely safe while a black piece dominates d4.

STORE THIS | In the KIA, d4 is the square White concedes; monitor who can use it and why.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

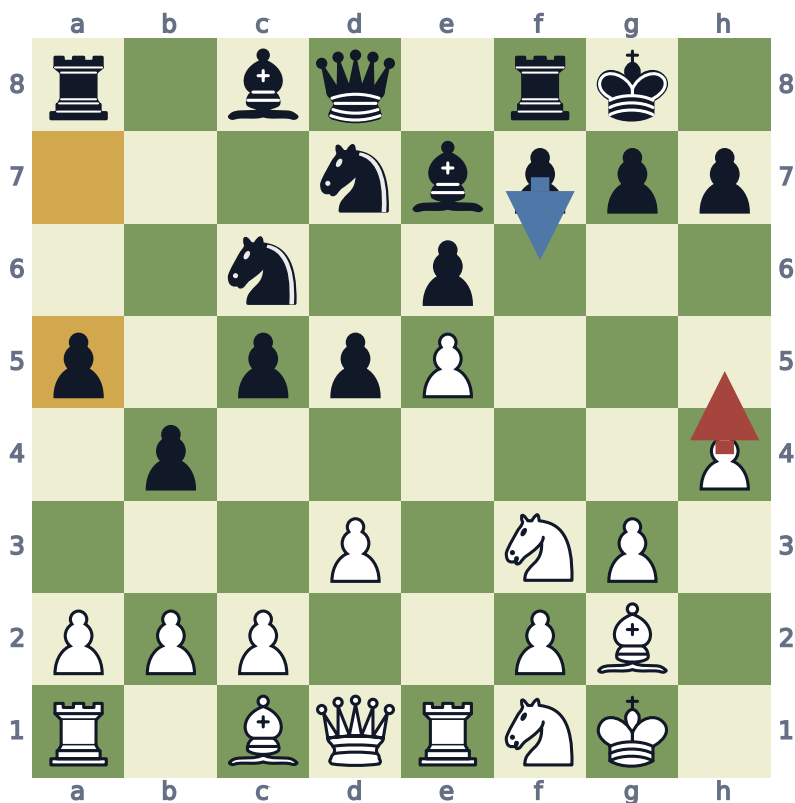
1. Because White's pawn stands on d3 rather than d4, Black often receives the d4 outpost for a knight or bishop and can use it to interrupt the attack. 2. Black occupies d4 when it cannot be chased, exchanges a key attacker, and coordinates queenside pressure with the central outpost. 3. White controls d4 with c3 or reroutes pieces so an occupation can be exchanged without ruining the attack. 4. Is d4 a harmless square, a blockading square, or an entry square that creates a concrete threat? 5. Treating the closed center as completely safe while a black piece dominates d4.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The d4 outpost



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Because White's pawn stands on d3 rather than d4, Black often receives the d4 outpost for a knight or bishop and can use it to interrupt the attack.

DECISION RULE

Is d4 a harmless square, a blockading square, or an entry square that creates a concrete threat?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black occupies d4 when it cannot be chased, exchanges a key attacker, and coordinates queenside pressure with the central outpost.

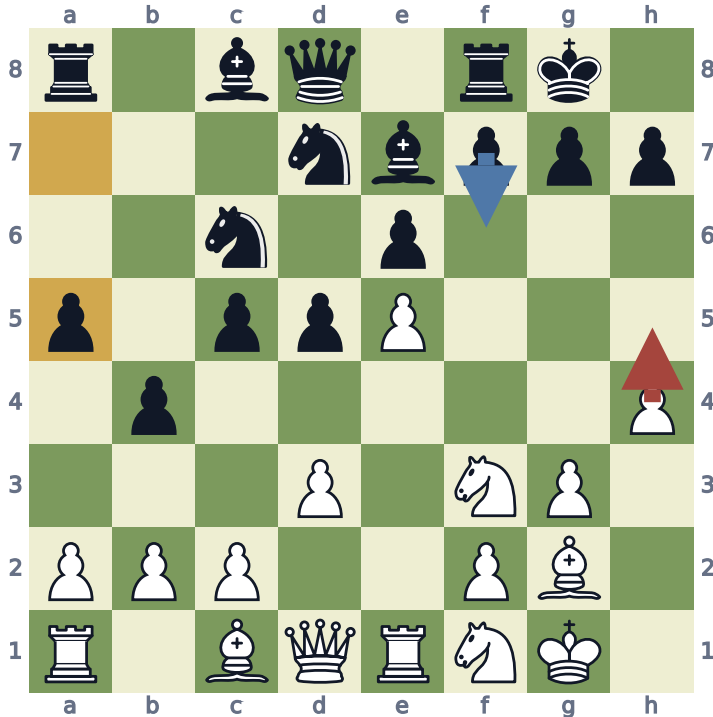
WHITE'S PLAN

White controls d4 with c3 or reroutes pieces so an occupation can be exchanged without ruining the attack.

MEMORY RULE | In the KIA, d4 is the square White concedes; monitor who can use it and why.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Because White's pawn stands on d3 rather than d4, Black often receives the d4 outpost for a knight or bishop and can use it to interrupt the attack.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black occupies d4 when it cannot be chased, exchanges a key attacker, and coordinates queenside pressure with the central outpost.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White controls d4 with c3 or reroutes pieces so an occupation can be exchanged without ruining the attack.

FAILURE MODE

Treating the closed center as completely safe while a black piece dominates d4.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Is d4 a harmless square, a blockading square, or an entry square that creates a concrete threat? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

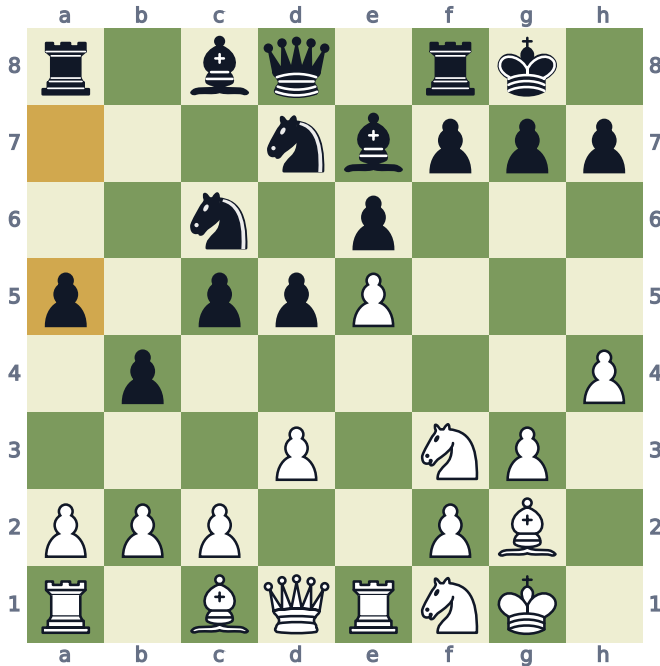
RULE | In the KIA, d4 is the square White concedes; monitor who can use it and why.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 b4 11. Nf1 a5



- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- h4: White creates a possible kingside hook and supports h5.
- b4: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- Nf1: White reroutes a knight to f1; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Because White's pawn stands on d3 rather than d4, Black often receives the d4 outpost for a knight or bishop and can use it to interrupt the attack.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Is d4 a harmless square, a blockading square, or an entry square that creates a concrete threat? White's attacking or positional plan is: White controls d4 with c3 or reroutes pieces so an occupation can be exchanged without ruining the attack. The line fails as a template when: Treating the closed center as completely safe while a black piece dominates d4.

STORE THIS | In the KIA, d4 is the square White concedes; monitor who can use it and why.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. Because White's pawn stands on d3 rather than d4, Black often receives the d4 outpost for a knight or bishop and can use it to interrupt the attack. 2. Black occupies d4 when it cannot be chased, exchanges a key attacker, and coordinates queenside pressure with the central outpost. 3. White controls d4 with c3 or reroutes pieces so an occupation can be exchanged without ruining the attack. 4. Is d4 a harmless square, a blockading square, or an entry square that creates a concrete threat? 5. Treating the closed center as completely safe while a black piece dominates d4.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 22 plies from memory, then replay: 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 b4 11. Nf1 a5

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 007 Decode: The e5 space wedge

Prompt: Can Black undermine e5 immediately, and which defender or recapture keeps White's pieces active?

Recall: e5 buys kingside space; White must use the space before Black attacks its base.

LESSON 008 Play: The e5 space wedge

Prompt: Can Black undermine e5 immediately, and which defender or recapture keeps White's pieces active?

Recall: e5 buys kingside space; White must use the space before Black attacks its base.

LESSON 009 Decode: The d3 base of the chain

Prompt: Which black piece can attack d3, and can White meet it with development rather than passive defense?

Recall: Attack from the head of the chain, but protect the base with the fewest pieces possible.

LESSON 010 Play: The d3 base of the chain

Prompt: Which black piece can attack d3, and can White meet it with development rather than passive defense?

Recall: Attack from the head of the chain, but protect the base with the fewest pieces possible.

LESSON 011 Decode: The d4 outpost

Prompt: Is d4 a harmless square, a blockading square, or an entry square that creates a concrete threat?

Recall: In the KIA, d4 is the square White concedes; monitor who can use it and why.

LESSON 012 Play: The d4 outpost

Prompt: Is d4 a harmless square, a blockading square, or an entry square that creates a concrete threat?

Recall: In the KIA, d4 is the square White concedes; monitor who can use it and why.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's counterplay, White's plan, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

The e5 space wedge

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4

Decision: Can Black undermine e5 immediately, and which defender or recapture keeps White's pieces active?

Memory: e5 buys kingside space; White must use the space before Black attacks its base.

CARD 2

The d3 base of the chain

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1

Decision: Which black piece can attack d3, and can White meet it with development rather than passive defense?

Memory: Attack from the head of the chain, but protect the base with the fewest pieces possible.

CARD 3

The d4 outpost

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 b4 11. Nf1 a5

Decision: Is d4 a harmless square, a blockading square, or an entry square that creates a concrete threat?

Memory: In the KIA, d4 is the square White concedes; monitor who can use it and why.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
007 Decode: The e5 space wedge	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
008 Play: The e5 space wedge	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
009 Decode: The d3 base of the chain	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
010 Play: The d3 base of the chain	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
011 Decode: The d4 outpost	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
012 Play: The d4 outpost	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name Black's strongest counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.